

Alex Moreau

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

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To:

Ms Adaeze Okonkwo
Head of Infrastructure
Northwind Payments
12 Finsbury Circus
London EC2M 7EA

Re: Staff Infrastructure Engineer (ref. NW-2291)

Dear Ms Adaeze Okonkwo,

I am writing about the Staff Infrastructure Engineer role. I have spent eleven years on payment and ledger systems, four of them at Stripe on the team responsible for the double-entry ledger, and Northwind is one of the few places doing that work at a scale where it is genuinely hard.

Your engineering blog's account of moving settlement off a shared primary described a problem I spent most of 2023 on. We took the ledger's p99 commit latency from 340ms to 45ms without weakening the audit guarantees the finance team depends on, and retired the last single point of failure in the payments path across forty services.

- **Ledger reliability.** Rebuilt a write path handling £4.2bn a year, with no customer-visible incident during the migration.
- **On-call that people can live with.** Cut paging volume 60% at Monzo by fixing the three alerts responsible for most of it rather than by raising thresholds.
- **Writing things down.** Wrote the incident review process now used across Stripe; median time to a published review fell from nine days to two.

Yours sincerely,

Alex Moreau